A Spanish edition of *Magnifica Humanitas*

A brief for a writer. Written in English with Spanish where Spanish is the point — the writer will be bilingual; the person commissioning it is not.

A note for whoever is reading this

If you are being asked for a recommendation: we are looking for someone to write the Spanish edition of a small publication on Pope Leo XIV's 2026 encyclical *Magnifica Humanitas*. The role is set out below. If a name comes to mind, we would be grateful — and if the person is you, so much the better.

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1. The publication

Magnifica Humanitas is a commentary publication on the encyclical of the same name: human dignity in the age of artificial intelligence. It is small, deliberate, and citation-driven — every claim about the document traces to the document.

The English edition is live at **https://magnifica.catholic.work**.

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2. What we are asking for

A **Spanish edition** — written in Spanish, not translated into it.

We are not looking for a translation service. A translation is a derivative of the English text, and it will always read as one. What we want is a Spanish edition that stands on its own: same sources, same arguments, written by someone for whom Spanish is the language of thought.

There is one Spanish page online today, the encyclical's own page:

https://magnifica.catholic.work/es/documents/magnifica-humanitas/

Its quotations are correct — they come from the Vatican's Spanish text. Its short editorial notes were written by us, and we are not native writers. That gap is the reason for this brief.

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3. Two kinds of text, handled in opposite ways

This is the most important thing in this document.

	QUOTED FROM THE ENCYCLICAL	OUR OWN WRITING
what	sentences of *Magnifica Humanitas*	essays, introductions, notes, summaries
how	**looked up** in the official Spanish edition	**written** in Spanish
latitude	none	full, within the register below

Quotations are never translated

The Holy See has issued *Magnifica Humanitas* in Spanish as well as English. The Spanish edition is not a translation of the English edition — it is the same document in Spanish, with its own settled wording, and it is authoritative for Spanish.

So when our Spanish page quotes the encyclical, the quotation is taken from the official Spanish text at vatican.va, **character for character**. It is never machine-translated from our English, and never restated in other words inside quotation marks.

The reason is not stylistic. Translating a papal quotation and presenting it as a quotation attributes to the Holy See wording it did not write. A misquotation of a papal document, however small, is not a matter of taste.

Our own prose is written

Essays, introductions, notes and summaries are written in Spanish by the writer. This is where the work is, and this is why we are looking for a writer rather than a translator.

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4. The register

The Spanish edition should read to the Holy Father as his own.

Robert Francis Prevost became a Peruvian citizen in 2015. He served as a missionary in Piura from 1985 and was Bishop of Chiclayo from 2015 to 2023. Northern Peruvian Spanish is the language of his episcopate — not a stylistic flourish we have chosen for effect.

Target: the formal preferences of northern Peru — Piura, Chulucanas, the Diocese of Chiclayo — **used in a general way.**

Two boundaries, and both matter:

- **Formal, not popular.** This is the vocabulary a Peruvian bishop would preach in, not the vocabulary of the street. A doctrinal publication is no place for regional slang.
- **Regional, not parochial.** A reader in Lima, in Mexico City, or in Madrid should find nothing foreign in it. The regionalism stops at vocabulary.

In practice:

- ***usted* throughout.** Never *tú*, never *vosotros*. Formal address is native register here, not stiffness.
- **First person plural (*nosotros*)** for the Church's own voice, as the official text does: «debemos recordar», «no podemos limitarnos».
- **Latin American vocabulary**, not Peninsular.

NOT (PENINSULAR)	USE
móvil	**celular**
ordenador	**computadora**
coche	**auto**, **carro**
zumo	**jugo**
vosotros	**ustedes**

No diminutives in doctrinal prose. No local idioms.

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5. Ecclesial vocabulary is not a matter of preference

Where the Holy See has settled how a term is rendered in Spanish, we use its rendering rather than inventing a better one.

The glossary holds 27 locked terms, every one of them checked against the official Spanish text. A sample:

ENGLISH	SPANISH (LOCKED)
human dignity	**dignidad humana**
the human person	**la persona humana**
artificial intelligence	**inteligencia artificial** (abbreviated **IA**)
the custody of the human person	**la custodia de la persona humana**
the social doctrine of the Church	**la Doctrina social de la Iglesia**
technology, as a human activity	**la técnica** — distinct from *la tecnología*
the Magisterium	**el Magisterio**
Pope Leo XIV	**el Papa León XIV** / **León XIV**

This table is a gate, not a suggestion. It is what keeps a publication reading as one publication rather than as a series of independent renderings.

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6. Citations follow the Spanish convention, not the English one

The two conventions differ, and each language follows its own.

	ENGLISH	SPANISH
scripture	Mt 25:14-30	**Mt 25,14-30** — comma, not colon
a paragraph of the encyclical	MH 107	**MH, n. 107**

Magnifica Humanitas stays in Latin, in italics, untranslated. So does *Rerum novarum*.

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7. Emphasis carries the argument and is reproduced exactly

The official text italicises words that are load-bearing. From MH 118:

> En cambio, debemos recordar que el ser humano no florece *a pesar* del límite, sino a menudo *a través* del límite.

The italics on *a pesar* and *a través* **are the argument** — the reversal from "despite" to "through". The sentence still reads without them; it no longer says what the author said.

So emphasis is reproduced exactly as the Holy See set it — and never added. Putting italics into a quotation the Holy See did not italicise emphasises on the Pope's behalf, which is the same fault in the other direction.

In the official Spanish text, emphasis falls in MH 4, MH 9, MH 89 and MH 118. That is the complete list.

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8. How the work would run

To begin, you would need no account and no access to anything. We would send you:

- this brief and the full glossary;
- the English piece to be rendered;
- the official Spanish text of every passage quoted.

You would return a Spanish document. We handle publication — layout, metadata, and the code that renders emphasis and citations correctly.

There is no deadline pressure and no obligation. If it turns out not to be a good fit, we would much rather know early than late.

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9. What good looks like

The checklist we run before anything publishes. We are showing it to you now so that nothing arrives as a surprise later.

- ☐ Every quotation matches the official Spanish edition **character for character**, emphasis included.
- ☐ Every quotation traces to the **Spanish** source, not to a translation of our English.
- ☐ No paraphrase inside quotation marks.
- ☐ Locked terms follow the glossary; no synonyms invented for them.
- ☐ *usted* throughout; no *vosotros*.
- ☐ No Peninsular vocabulary.
- ☐ Citations use the Spanish convention.
- ☐ *Magnifica Humanitas* untranslated and in italics.
- ☐ **The piece reads end to end as Spanish** — not as English in Spanish words. This is the one no checklist catches, and it is the one that matters.

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10. Credit, and two practical matters

By-line. Every piece on the site carries a by-line, and the Spanish edition would carry its writer's. The work should be attributed to the person who wrote it — with a link to a parish, a school, an order or other work if that is useful. We would simply ask how the writer prefers to be named: full name, with a title, or with a religious name.

Copyright. We quote the encyclical only in short passages and link to the full text at vatican.va. We do not reproduce papal documents, and any Spanish edition would keep to the same rule.

If the writer is a priest or a religious. We would rather raise this early than have it become a difficulty later.

- A member of a religious institute requires the permission of his major superior to publish writings on religion or morals — **canon 832** of the Code of Canon Law.
- A diocesan priest is not bound in the same way, though submitting writings on religion and morals to the judgment of the local ordinary is *recommended* — **canon 827 §3**.

We are not canonists and would not presume to advise. The canons are here so that a priest can read them rather than take our word for it:

https://www.vatican.va/archive/cod-iuris-canonici/eng/documents/cic_lib3-cann822-833_en.html

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11. Next step

Write to us. If you would like to see the whole thing before deciding, we will send the full translation standard, the complete glossary, and a piece to work from. There is no commitment in looking at it.